

pulled downwards due to gravity and purified. A micro-fibre mesh is also present between the two compartments and filters to remove larger impurities before water gets filtered through activated carbon or UF filter.

Price increases from gravity to UV to RO to RO + UV for the same capacity. For the same technology, price increases with increase in storage capacity as well.

Quantity of total dissolved solids (TDS) decides the softness and hardness of water. Soft water has TDS of 1ppm to 200ppm, and needs UV or gravity water purifier. Hard water, which has TDS between 200ppm and 3000ppm, needs an RO-based water purifier.

Food processors

Many people get confused between a grinder, mixer, juicer and food processor. How can you choose which one you need? Answer to this question is given below.

Juicers are of three types: centrifugal, cold press and electric citrus. A centrifugal juicer rotates at a high speed to slice and dice food, allowing

the juices to flow free. It is fast, easy to assemble/disassemble, affordable but noisy, and heat from it potentially reduces juice quality.

A cold press juicer makes use of gears instead of blades, and grinds food instead of slicing it.

Juice from a centrifugal juicer stays fresh for lesser time than from a cold press juicer. Cold press creates less noise, takes less preparation time and there is less food wastage.

A mixer mixes various cooking ingredients, usually in a semi-liquid state, for example, purees, vegetable pastes for making curry and batters for cooking. A grinder is a comparatively

stronger machine used to grind substances into a powdery form. It is commonly used for grinding cereals, lentils and spices, and can be dry or wet.

Whether you choose a food processor, mixer, grinder or juicer combo, it must have at least four jars—one for dry grinding like spices, second for wet grinding like *chutneys*, third for liquidising or for mixing shakes and the like, and fourth for juicing.

Wattage defines power of the motor—the higher

the wattage, the heavier the load it can sustain. A regular Indian kitchen mixer can work with a 550W to 600W motor; anything above can become noisy. However, you can go for higher wattages if you have to grind larger quantities. To grind more than one kilogram of lentils (for batter) in one go, you will need a motor with minimum wattage of 750W.

rpm is the abbreviated form of rotations per minute—the higher the rpm, the more powerful the motor. This reduces the time required for processing the ingredients. But, higher rpm can heat up the machine and make it noisy; anything from 18,000rpm to 23,000rpm is good enough.

Mixer grinders that have a speed control knob/switch allow changing the settings as per requirement. Warranty of two to five years is required—an additional warranty on the motor is ideal.

The ideal mixer is one that has overload protection features like a circuit breaker to stop the appliance. You can remove some of the load and reset the switch. Absence of a safety factor can cause early burnout of the motor.

Make a list of the required features in your new appliance to make a smart choice. If you are investing money, invest in quality. For home appliances like smart TVs, air-coolers, air-purifiers, microwaves, air-conditioners and cameras, please refer to our previous articles. **EFY**



Gravity water purifier versus RO+UV water purifier (Credit: www.flipkart.com)



Four-jar mixer, grinder and juicer (Credit: www.paiinternational.in)